



Separation Support

Premium practice worksheet

SEPARATION SUPPORT - LESSON 01

Know what you are actually treating.

Use this worksheet to help owners distinguish between typical adjustment challenges and true separation-related distress so the next steps are safe and realistic.

TRAINER NOTE

A dog that is panicking when left alone needs a different plan than a dog who is simply learning a new routine.

START HERE

Dog: _____

Date: _____

Owner: _____

Best reward: _____

1 What success looks like

By the end of this lesson, the owner can describe their dog's main alone-time behaviors, note likely triggers, and identify whether the pattern looks more like mild adjustment or

2 Practice plan

1

Define the behavior

Write down what your dog actually does when left alone: pacing, barking, drooling,

2

Track the timing

Note how soon the behavior starts and whether your dog can recover at any point.

3

Look for patterns

Identify whether the reaction happens with all departures or only certain situations.

4

Choose the right plan

Use your notes to decide whether you should focus on training, management, or



Separation Support

Separation Anxiety vs. Normal Adjustment

3 Supplies and setup

Supplies needed

- ☐ Phone or camera to observe alone-time behavior
- ☐ Notebook or tracking sheet
- ☐ List of common signs of stress
- ☐ A calm, safe alone-time setup

Set up before you start

- ☐ Observe instead of guessing whenever possible.
- ☐ Choose one alone-time setup to evaluate at first.
- ☐ Focus on body language, not just noise level.

4 Alone-time behavior observation log

Date	Setup	Time alone	Behavior seen	Recovery?	Notes

5 5-day practice micro plan

Day 1

Set baseline

Find the easiest version and keep it calm.

Day 2

Repeat wins

Practice the same setup until it looks smooth.

Day 3

Add one tiny step

Add only one small challenge if yesterday

Day 4

Hold or simplify

If your puppy struggled, make today easier.

Day 5

Review notes

Choose the safest next step from your log.



Separation Support

Separation Anxiety vs. Normal Adjustment

6 Common mistakes and quick fixes

Common mistakes

- Assuming all barking means severe separation anxiety.
- Using memory alone instead of recording behavior.
- Judging the dog only by the loudest moments.
- Pushing longer absences before understanding the pattern.

If this happens, try this

- If you are unsure what the dog does, use video and review it calmly later.
- If the dog escalates immediately, pause duration-building and focus on management first.
- If the pattern changes by setup, track each setup separately.

7 Ready to progress?

- ☐ I can describe what my dog does when left alone.
- ☐ I know how quickly the behavior starts.
- ☐ I have video or notes from at least several reps.
- ☐ I know whether my dog looks mildly uncomfortable or truly distressed.

HOMEWORK

Record three to five short alone-time observations this week. Write down what behavior started first, how quickly it began, and whether your dog showed any signs of recovery.

8 Owner reflection

Biggest win: _____

What made it easier: _____

What should I repeat tomorrow: _____

QUESTIONS FOR YOUR FITDOG TRAINER

What should I make easier? _____

What should I practice again? _____

What is the next realistic step? _____